changes but vary with each locality, example: basic clothing like inner wear. The modish type predominates in the western countries and changes rapidly in point of time over all parts of the world, which are subject to fashion changes, example: party wear dresses.

4.4 Types of Family



The first contact for every individual in this world is his family. The family is the most important part of a man's environment. The first contact of an individual in his environment is through his family. As civilization advanced the family continued to change which become more eminent due to industrialization and urbanization. Hence it is important to examine and understand the structure of the family in the modern setting.

In general, the family life cycle can be divided into three major stages.

- The beginning family
- The expanding family
- The contracting family

4.4.1 Nuclear Family

The nuclear family is the traditional type of family structure. This family type consists of parents and children. The nuclear family was accepted by society as the ideal family type to rise. Children in nuclear families receive strength and stability from the parents and generally have more opportunities due to the financial ease. Today's generation live in a nuclear family unit.

4.4.2 Single Parent Family

The single parent family consists of one parent raising one or more children on his own. Mostly a single parent family is a mother with her children and there are single fathers as well. The single parent family is the biggest change in the society which has changed the family structures. Single parent families are close and they have to solve problems and divide their household chores. In this type of family only one of the parents will be employed. This will limits the income and their opportunities.

4.4.3 Extended Family

The extended family structure consists of two or more adults who are related, either by blood or marriage living in the same home. This type of family includes many relatives living together and working towards common goals such as raising the children and managing the household duties. The extended families include cousins, aunts or uncle and grandparents living together. This type of family structure has more financial difficulties because older relatives are unable to care for themselves alone. Extended families are becoming increasingly common all over the world.

4.4.4 Childless Family

Majority of people think of family as including children, they are couples who either cannot or choose not to have children. The childless family is sometimes the "forgotten family" as it does not meet the traditional standards set by society. Childless families consist of a husband and wife living and working together. Many childless families take on

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